

PickleBallers Owner App Meeting

Reconstructed meeting notes with transcript-style discussion, product analysis, decisions, risks, and next actions. Prepared from the available TurboScribe transcription, which ends mid-discussion because the uploaded file is limited.

Purpose: This document is meant for team members and stakeholders who were not able to attend the recorded meeting. It preserves the flow of the discussion while cleaning up the raw transcript and adding product interpretation where useful.

1. Executive Readout

The meeting centered on whether PickleBallers should prioritize the court-owner side of the platform, how early the team should show it to venue owners, and what the owner app must include before it is credible enough to present.

The shared conclusion was not simply to build a small MVP. The stronger direction is to build the most viable owner product possible within the current timeline: practical enough for a real venue to use, polished enough to avoid a weak first impression, and flexible enough to handle common venue requirements such as manual bookings, variable pricing, memberships, multiple courts, and possibly multiple sports.

Theme	What Was Discussed	Product Meaning
Owner app priority	Some felt the venue-owner side should be prioritized because venues are the supply side of the marketplace.	Owner tools must be useful even before player volume is high.
Do not show too early	There was concern that if owners see a weak product, it will be harder to re-approach them later.	The first demo must feel credible and relevant to their actual venue operations.
Transition from current workflows	Owners may already use phone calls, Messenger, Instagram, Excel, Playport, Playby Point, or similar tools.	The app should support manual blocking and gradual migration rather than forcing a hard switch.
Differentiation	Existing booking platforms are common, and some may already be free.	The real carrot is demand generation: bringing players, filling dead slots, rebooking, and marketing the venue.
Feature fit per venue	Different venues need different things: memberships, peak pricing, multi-sport support, different approval rules.	The team needs a structured requirement sheet and a realistic development timeline.

2. Cleaned Meeting Narrative With Analysis

2.1 Owner App Versus Player App Priority

Cleaned discussion: The discussion opened with the question of whether the back end or owner-facing side of the app could be launched to court owners first. One view was that if resources had to be allocated to one side, the court-owner side should be prioritized. Another concern was that both sides still matter: if venues are onboarded but players cannot actually book through the app, the platform may not yet be convincing.

Analysis: This is a classic two-sided marketplace issue. PickleBallers needs court supply and player demand, but the owner app can still provide value before full demand exists if it acts as a scheduling and booking-management tool. The product should therefore be designed so owners can use it for current operations, not only for future PickleBallers-driven bookings.

2.2 Current Venue Operations Must Be Respected

Cleaned discussion: The team talked about how venue owners may be operating today. Some may receive bookings through phone calls, Facebook Messenger, Instagram, or direct messages, then manually enter those into Excel, a scheduling app, or another booking platform. The suggestion was that PickleBallers should include this manual input capability so owners can transition slowly without disrupting their existing operations.

Analysis: This is one of the most important points in the meeting. The owner app should not assume that all bookings originate from PickleBallers. It needs a scheduler where owners or staff can manually block slots from outside channels, while app-generated bookings automatically fill the same calendar. This makes the app useful as a venue operations tool, not just as a marketplace add-on.

2.3 Competitive Landscape And Why Owners Need A Strong Reason

Cleaned discussion: The group mentioned that some venues already use tools like Playport or Playby Point, while some venues rely mainly on Instagram or no formal booking system. Sports360 was also mentioned as an example of a free or competing platform. The concern was that there are already many booking platforms, so owners need a reason beyond basic scheduling.

Analysis: The app should not be pitched as only another booking platform. The stronger value proposition is that PickleBallers helps owners increase utilization by bringing players to courts, promoting open slots, encouraging rebooking, and making venues more discoverable. The marketplace, player network, and marketing layer are the real differentiators.

2.4 The Risk Of Approaching Owners Too Early

Cleaned discussion: A major concern was that the team may only get one strong first impression with each venue. If a venue owner sees the product and finds that it lacks something important, such as membership pricing, it may be difficult to return later and convince them again. The transcript compared this to previous experience where approaching too early made a second approach harder.

Analysis: This does not mean the team should wait forever. It means the first owner-facing demo should feel targeted and credible. Before approaching a specific venue, the team should know that venue's likely requirements and confirm the demo can address them. For example, a venue with memberships should not be approached until member pricing is at least properly represented in the product plan or prototype.

2.5 MVP Versus Most Viable Product

Cleaned discussion: There was a suggestion to create a minimum viable product that is decent enough to show owners, with some future features visible but not yet fully enabled. This was refined by another view: the goal should not be the smallest possible MVP, but the most viable product the team can build within the chosen timeframe.

Analysis: The recommended framing is: most viable product within the timeline. That means the team should map features, estimate effort, and weigh the risk of not having each feature. Some features must be functional. Some can be shown as coming soon. But the total experience must feel useful, serious, and relevant to the venue.

2.6 Need For A Structured Development Timeline

Cleaned discussion: The team acknowledged that they are still partly flying blind. One suggestion was to build a structured development timeline: list the features, estimate how long each will take, and decide which features must be included before sales outreach. More frequent meetings were suggested so progress can be reviewed and corrected while development continues.

Analysis: This should become a product planning artifact. The owner app needs a feature-priority matrix that shows what is required for the first owner demo, what can follow shortly after, and what belongs to the roadmap. Without this, the team may build impressive screens while missing the exact things owners need to say yes.

3. Demo Walkthrough Notes

3.1 Current PWA And Owner Login

Cleaned discussion: During the meeting, the team opened the current PWA and checked how it behaves on mobile and desktop. The first page presents two major choices from the player perspective: play or book. The discussion then moved into the owner perspective by logging in with test accounts.

Analysis: The current product already has visible progress and can be used for walkthroughs. However, the owner flow needs to be sharpened around what an owner or operator expects to see first: revenue, current bookings, upcoming bookings, venue status, and actionable management tasks.

3.2 Owner Dashboard Expectations

Cleaned discussion: The team described the owner dashboard as showing the owner what matters most: how much money the venue is making, current bookings, upcoming bookings,

occupancy, and other venue-related benefits. The assumption was that a rich owner with multiple venues would want to see performance immediately.

Analysis: This is directionally correct, but the document should distinguish between owner and operator users. Owners may care most about total revenue, occupancy, and business performance. Operators or staff may care more about today's schedule, pending approvals, manual booking entries, cancellations, and customer inquiries.

3.3 Venue Creation And Location Setup

Cleaned discussion: The demo showed creating a venue, including venue name, location, and related information. A key comment was that owners should not have to manually pin the map. They should be able to enter the address or postcode, and the app should automatically find or suggest the correct map location, similar to Google Business Profile setup.

Analysis: Venue creation should reduce friction. Address autocomplete and auto-geocoding should be treated as a practical requirement, not a decorative feature. The easier the setup, the more likely owners and staff will complete the listing accurately.

3.4 Venue, Court, And Pricing Hierarchy

Cleaned discussion: The team clarified that the product has a hierarchy: a venue can have multiple courts, and pricing should be tied mostly to the court because different courts may have different rates. The demo showed adding courts and setting details such as surface, description, and thumbnail or photos.

Analysis: The hierarchy should be explicit in the product model: Owner > Venue > Court > Schedule/Availability > Pricing Rules > Bookings. This matters because most real requirements, including peak pricing and court-specific rules, depend on court-level configuration rather than venue-level configuration alone.

3.5 Booking Approval Options

Cleaned discussion: The demo mentioned that when someone books a venue or court, the owner can either approve bookings manually or allow automatic approval. There was agreement that this should be configurable per venue or court.

Analysis: Auto-approval is useful for simple operations, but manual approval may be required for venues that still coordinate staff, membership rules, payment confirmation, or special events. The first version should support both modes clearly.

3.6 Booking Links And Website Integration

Cleaned discussion: The team questioned why the owner would manually enter a booking link. The better assumption was that PickleBallers should generate the booking link automatically. There may still be a website field for the venue's own website, and the generated PickleBallers booking link could be embedded or shared from that website.

Analysis: Booking links should be system-generated, with optional custom slugs. For example, a venue may have a branded listing URL, but uniqueness and routing should be handled by the platform. The venue website field and the PickleBallers booking link should be separate

fields.

4. Requirements Surfaced During Discussion

Requirement	Why It Came Up	Recommended Priority
Manual booking/blocking	Owners receive bookings outside the app through calls, Messenger, Instagram, or walk-ins.	Must have for owner demo
Auto-generated booking link	The team agreed owners should not manually create platform booking URLs.	Must have
Multiple venues per owner	A rich owner may manage more than one location.	Must have
Multiple courts per venue	Venues may have several courts with separate details and schedules.	Must have
Court-level pricing	Pricing depends on court, time, and possibly sport or surface.	Must have
Peak/off-peak pricing	Rates may change after 6 PM, weekends, or high-demand periods.	High priority
Member pricing	Some venues have membership options and special rates.	High priority if target venue uses memberships
Manual or automatic approval	Owners need control over how bookings are confirmed.	High priority
Address autocomplete and map pin	Owners may not know how to manually pin a location.	High priority
Multi-sport support	A venue may manage badminton, pickleball, and other sports in one facility.	Strategic priority
Profile completion prompts	The app encourages owners to complete venue information.	Medium priority
Platform-curated highlights	The team agreed owners should not invent claims like 'what players like'.	Medium priority
Dynamic pricing suggestions	The team discussed future data-driven price recommendations.	Roadmap
Demand analytics	Data could show busy hours, low-demand slots, and price opportunities.	Roadmap after enough data

5. Pricing Discussion

Cleaned discussion: Pricing became one of the densest parts of the discussion. The team noted that many venues charge different rates depending on time. For example, one price may apply before 6 PM and a higher price after 6 PM. Member pricing may be different again. The suggestion was made that pricing should live near hours or schedule settings because price is tied to time.

Analysis: The pricing system should start with owner-controlled rules, then evolve into optional dynamic recommendations. The first version should not require a complex algorithm to be useful. It should let owners configure practical pricing rules: standard rate, peak rate, weekend rate, member rate, and possibly court-specific overrides.

Pricing Layer	Description	Phase
Base court price	Default hourly rate for a court.	Initial owner app
Time-based price	Different pricing by hour or time block, such as 6 PM onward.	Initial or near-term
Day-based price	Different pricing for weekdays, weekends, or holidays.	Near-term
Member price	Special rate for venue members.	Target-venue dependent
Manual surge adjustment	Owner can increase or decrease rates for specific slots.	Near-term
Suggested dynamic pricing	Platform recommends price changes based on demand patterns.	Roadmap
Automated dynamic pricing	Platform adjusts pricing based on demand, if owner opts in.	Later roadmap

6. Dynamic Pricing And Analytics

Cleaned discussion: The team compared dynamic pricing to surge pricing in taxi or ride-hailing apps and also mentioned revenue management for Airbnb-like businesses. One possible model was that after the app gathers enough data, it can detect that a certain time slot has high demand and recommend a higher rate. If demand stays strong, the suggested price could increase again.

Analysis: This should be treated as a staged feature. Before dynamic pricing can be trusted, the platform needs enough booking, search, view, and availability data. The first useful analytics layer should be actionable: which times are busiest, which slots are underused, which courts generate the most revenue, and where the owner may raise or lower prices.

Recommended staged approach:

1. Let owners manually set clear pricing rules first.
2. Collect demand data from searches, views, booking attempts, completed bookings,

cancellations, and empty slots.

3. Show simple insights such as busiest hours, underused hours, and revenue by court.
4. Introduce suggested pricing changes, but keep the owner in control.
5. Only later consider automatic dynamic pricing as an opt-in feature.

7. Multi-Sport Venue Issue

Cleaned discussion: The team raised an important friction point: many venues may be multi-sport facilities. If a venue currently manages badminton, pickleball, and other courts in one platform, asking them to manage only pickleball in PickleBallers could become a major inconvenience.

Analysis: The product does not need to become a full multi-sport marketplace immediately, but the owner-side data model should not block it. A court should be able to have a sport/type field. This protects the app from future rework and makes it easier to onboard venues that think operationally by facility, not only by pickleball.

8. Master Sheet Recommendation

A centralized master sheet was suggested during the meeting. This should become the shared source of truth for nuanced product questions, venue requirements, assumptions, and decisions. It will help the team avoid repeating the same unresolved questions in every meeting.

Column	Purpose
Topic	Example: Pricing, Membership, Venue Setup, Multi-Sport, Booking Approval
Question / Requirement	The exact question or requirement raised by the team or a venue.
Source	Meeting, stakeholder, target venue, competitor research, or client feedback.
Priority	Must have, high, medium, low, roadmap.
Needed before owner demo?	Yes, no, or target-venue dependent.
Decision	What the team decided, if already resolved.
Owner	Who will investigate, design, or implement.
Status	Open, in progress, decided, implemented, deferred.

9. Recommended Owner App Demo Readiness Checklist

Before approaching a serious venue owner, the team should confirm the demo can show the following:

- Owner can log in and immediately see venue performance, today's bookings, upcoming

bookings, and revenue.

- Owner can create or edit a venue with address autocomplete and map location.
- Owner can add multiple courts under a venue.
- Owner can configure court availability and operating hours.
- Owner can set at least basic and peak pricing rules.
- Owner can manually block a time slot for phone, Messenger, Instagram, or walk-in bookings.
- Owner can choose manual approval or automatic approval for bookings.
- System can generate a venue or court booking link automatically.
- Booking link can be shared or embedded from the venue's own website.
- The product can explain future features like demand insights and dynamic pricing without pretending they are finished.

10. Product Positioning After This Meeting

The recommended owner pitch should not be: 'Here is another booking app.' The stronger pitch should be:

PickleBallers helps your venue get discovered, fill open court slots, manage bookings from both online and offline channels, and eventually make smarter pricing decisions based on real demand.

This positioning matters because owners may already have a booking process. The platform must show that it can improve revenue and reduce friction, not simply replace a tool they already use.

11. Decisions And Working Assumptions

- The owner app is strategically important and may deserve priority, but it should not be presented weakly.
- The team should aim for the most viable owner product within the current timeline, not a bare-minimum MVP.
- Venue onboarding should support gradual migration from existing workflows.
- Manual booking/blocking is essential because many bookings may still happen outside the platform.
- Pricing must support real-world variation by time, court, and possibly membership status.
- Dynamic pricing is valuable, but should come after enough data exists.
- The app should separate venue website links from platform-generated booking links.
- Platform-curated highlights should come from PickleBallers data or editorial review, not

purely owner-entered claims.

- A master requirement sheet should be created and maintained after each meeting.

12. Open Questions

- Which exact venues will be approached first, and what systems do they currently use?
- Which target venues require membership pricing before they would consider switching?
- Should multi-sport support be visible in the first owner demo or only supported in the data model?
- How much of pricing should be configured in the court settings versus the hours/schedule screen?
- What booking payment flow is required for the first demo: request only, deposit, full payment, or credits?
- Who is the main user of the owner dashboard: owner, manager, front-desk staff, or all three?
- What is the minimum credible analytics view before showing the product to venue owners?

13. Immediate Next Actions

Action	Reason	Suggested Owner
Create the master requirements sheet	Capture nuanced questions and prevent repeated unresolved discussions.	Product lead
Map owner MVP features by priority	Separate must-have demo features from roadmap items.	Product + dev
Research first target venues	Avoid demoing without knowing whether they need memberships, multi-sport support, or special pricing.	Business/dev team
Refine venue creation flow	Address autocomplete, map pinning, booking-link generation, and court hierarchy.	Dev/design
Design pricing rules screen	Pricing is a core adoption requirement for real venues.	Product/design
Add manual booking/blocking flow	Supports transition from phone, Messenger, Instagram, and walk-in bookings.	Dev
Schedule recurring demo reviews	Let stakeholders correct the product while it is being built.	Project lead

14. Final Summary

The meeting clarified that the owner app is not just a back-office feature. It is one of the main reasons venues may join the platform. However, the team should be careful with timing and presentation. Venue owners are likely busy, already using some process, and sensitive to missing features. The safest approach is to build a practical, credible owner product that supports existing workflows first, then layer in the stronger marketplace advantages: player discovery, rebooking, open-slot promotion, analytics, and dynamic pricing.